You have made accusations about U.S. policy which I cannot accept. My purpose here, however, is not to debate, but search for a way out of the pattern by which one of us becomes involved, directly or indirectly, in military disputes and then stimulates the reaction of the other, so that which should be of local concern is turned into a Soviet-American confrontation.

As I have said, I believe it is the Soviet Union which has acted without restraint to that respect, and the Soviet Union says it is the United States. An agreement as to who is to blame is not necessary to find a solution. We must find a way to terminate the military involvement, direct and indirect, of both our countries in these disputes and avoid spreading such involvement. . . .

This is the goal of the proposal I made last October and I want to encourage the parties to the conflict to find political solutions while both our countries support the process by agreeing to terminate the flow of weapons and war material into the area of conflict.

There are many points upon which we still disagree and we will probably never reach agreement on some of them. Nevertheless, I'm convinced the critical problems can be solved if we approach them in a proper manner.

I have the feeling we are gradually finding some additional points upon which we can agree and I hope that by concentrating on practical solutions we can give greater momentum to the process.

I feel we have to speed up the negotiating process if it is to occur and I hope you will instruct your delegation in Geneva, as I have instructed ours, to roll up their sleeves and get seriously to work.

When you announced to the public the ideas contained in your letter of January 14, I made a